

John Charles

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Infrastructure Engineer with 15 years in DevOps/Infrastructure, currently at IBM. I work at the point where architecture meets delivery: setting technical direction, then staying close enough to the code to know whether it held. Strongest in GitHub Actions, Kafka and Ansible.

CAREER HISTORY

Infrastructure Engineer

IBM | May 2015 – Present

- Designed the multi-region failover strategy and led the game-day exercises that proved it.
- Migrated 15 services to Ansible, cutting monthly infrastructure spend by 15%.
- Cut container image sizes by 15%, shortening cold starts across the fleet.
- Led the Kubernetes upgrade across 4 clusters with zero customer-visible downtime.

Site Reliability Engineer, Summit Digital

Mar 2013 – May 2015

- Automated 3 manual runbooks, saving an estimated 10 engineer-hours per month.
- Built CI/CD pipelines with Ansible, bringing mean time to deploy under 2 minutes.
- Reduced incident MTTR from 5 hours to under 40 minutes with better alert routing and runbooks.

Microsoft — Infrastructure Engineer

Mar 2012 – Feb 2013

- Ran the on-call rotation for 20 production services, sustaining 99.9% availability.
- Wrote the platform team's paved-road documentation, cutting onboarding from weeks to days.

DevOps Engineer

BrightPath Solutions | Oct 2010 – Oct 2011

- Introduced secret rotation and least-privilege IAM across 30 accounts.
- Built observability on GitHub Actions so teams could self-serve dashboards instead of filing tickets.

Junior Site Reliability Engineer, Cloudflare

Dec 2009 – May 2010

- Introduced infrastructure-as-code with Prometheus, eliminating manual provisioning entirely.
- Improved cluster utilisation by 22% through right-sizing and AWS autoscaling policies.

ACADEMIC HISTORY

PhD, Biology

Ashford Technical University | 2009

Relevant coursework: Cell Biology, Biostatistics, Bioinformatics, Genetics

Bachelor, Business Administration

Cedar Hollow University | 2005

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Bash, Python, JavaScript

Cloud & DevOps: GitHub Actions, Ansible, Nginx, AWS, Prometheus, GCP

Data: Kafka, Redis

Testing & Tooling: Cypress, GraphQL

PROJECTS

Technical blog

Writing up GitHub Actions experiments and failures, roughly 7k readers a month.

CERTIFICATES

Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) — ISC2, 2025

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) — Cloud Native Computing Foundation, 2026

PUBLICATIONS

"Population modelling under habitat fragmentation" - accepted at a peer-reviewed workshop, 2011.

LANGUAGE SKILLS

English – Native